and his philosophical outlook: “Leonard Freed saw, interpreted and transmitted in a particular way. He had a *Weltanschauung*. This term and its less-than-perfect translation, *worldview*, wraps beautifully around both Freed the man and Freed the photographer. … He used photography as a tool to better understand the world, first to himself (to discover who he was), and then for us (to help discover who we are).”[9] Freed’s perspective as it pertains to the Berlin Wall epitomizes the way his approach to photography was influenced by his ideas of how people relate to one another and the cultural landscapes that surround them, both formalistically and historically. In Germany, he considers its status as a “nation” as a way to ruminate on the connections between its divided people, places, and epochs. In the geopolitical spaces of divided Berlin, Freed attended to a range of reflections and relationships, determined by his own photographic frame or footsteps toward encounter. Freed pursued the meaning-making of a photographic image, both at the point of capture and later in editorial selection, where he could spatially and conceptually convey questions regarding identity and mutuality. By alternately turning toward the Berlin Wall and away from its tense border zones, he intended to mark historical dividing lines while seeking recognition across them. Freed treats the Wall and other sites and structures of division as symbols of geopolitical standoff and venues for critical engagement and studied connection between otherwise divided peoples.

Most of Freed’s photographs from the period of 1961–65 can be categorized by their inclusion in either his German or American portfolios; they were included in two books, *Black in White America* and *Made in Germany* (1970). Because of Berlin’s geopolitical situation, limiting Freed’s photographs at the Wall to only two national contexts becomes difficult. Yet by thinking through the overlapping national contexts in which Freed’s black soldier image may reasonably “belong,” we can trace his methodology of engaging historical dividing lines and the people who populate them. Freed maps his Berlin-based images in photobooks in order to mark and contest the Wall’s simplest narratives. Freed carefully calibrated a relative proximity with his subjects, at once moving closer to identify with them and allowing for a space of estrangement to capture the multiple historical and social buffers that he attempted to comprehend or overcome by the Wall.

This chapter explores Freed’s movements in and out of Berlin during the early years of the Berlin Wall, with an eye toward locating the single-shot